

Networking

This is another aspect of computing that has gotten better with time. Wi-Fi hotspot and USB tethering features built into today's smartphones mean that we no more have to rely solely on EDGE/3G networks. The low dependence on network interface configuration can be attributed to higher usage of Wi-Fi in homes and offices. And no matter which version of Linux you use, Wi-Fi support is almost always appreciated.

Plug and Play

Frankly, whoever came up with the phrase 'plug and play' must have been overoptimistic – few things work straight out of the box. When you plug in any device such as your pen drive, your OS looks for the appropriate drivers to use before you can actually play the plugged in device. For that to happen, your OS must at least have the generic drivers, if not the specific ones for the device. This has been a source of constant trouble.

While in the past, attaching a printer was tricky, now it's a walk in the park, especially with Linux. The driver support has been augmented to the point where even graphics cards that previously played spoilsport today work in harmony with the default open source drivers. Today, most major manufacturers are considering Linux when designing hardware and opening their arms slowly to the Linux community. Result: you can actually plug and play most of your peripherals.



Companies are making Linux-based laptops. Just ask for one from your vendor